

Deepfake Awareness and Media Trust Survey

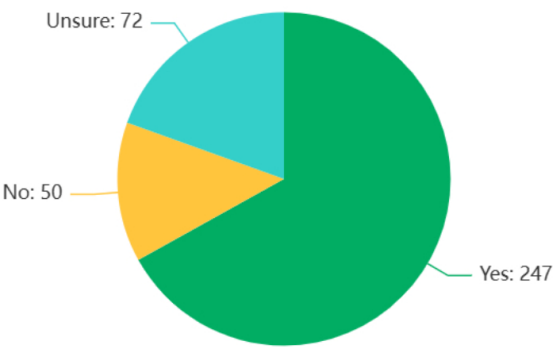
Preface

This survey aims to explore public awareness and perceptions of Deepfakes, a rapidly evolving technology that raises significant concerns regarding misinformation and manipulation. Through a series of questions, we seek to gauge the familiarity of respondents with Deepfakes, their experiences with manipulated media, and their confidence in identifying such content. Additionally, the survey examines concerns related to the misuse of Deepfakes and the potential for positive applications. Although we currently have no responses, the insights gathered from this survey will be invaluable in understanding societal attitudes toward Deepfakes and informing future discussions on media literacy and technology ethics.

1. Have you ever heard the term “Deepfake” before? [Multiple Choice]

Analysis Conclusion: The survey results indicate that a significant majority of respondents (66.94%) have heard of the term "Deepfake," suggesting a strong awareness of this concept among the participants. However, 19.51% are unsure about it, and 13.55% have never heard of it, indicating a gap in knowledge that could be addressed.

To improve awareness and understanding of deepfakes, it is recommended to implement educational initiatives such as workshops, webinars, or informational campaigns that target the unsure and uninformed groups. Additionally, providing clear and accessible resources about deepfakes could help enhance overall comprehension and engagement with the topic.

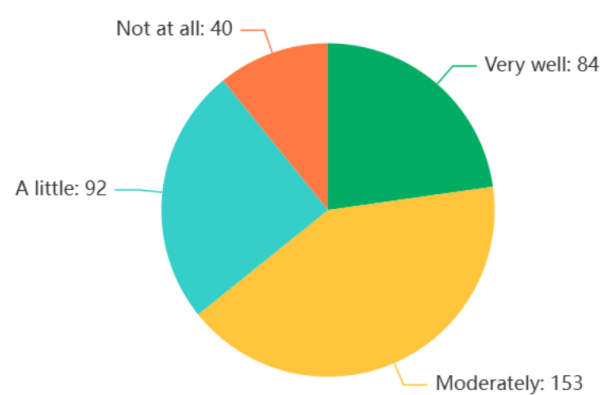


Answer Choices	Responses	Responses Percentage
Yes	247	66.94%
No	50	13.55%
Unsure	72	19.51%
Valid Count Per Participant	369	

2. How confident are you that you understand what a Deepfake is? [Multiple Choice]

Analysis Conclusion: The data indicates a moderate level of confidence among respondents regarding their understanding of Deepfakes. The largest group, comprising 41.46%, feels moderately confident, while a significant portion (22.76%) claims to understand it very well. However, there is also a notable percentage (24.93%) who only have a little understanding, and 10.84% who do not understand Deepfakes at all.

This suggests that while many respondents have some level of awareness, there is a considerable opportunity for educational initiatives to enhance understanding. To improve overall comprehension, it is recommended to implement targeted educational campaigns, workshops, or informational resources that explain Deepfakes and their implications in a clear and accessible manner. Additionally, addressing the concerns of those who feel they understand "a little" or "not at all" could help bridge the knowledge gap.



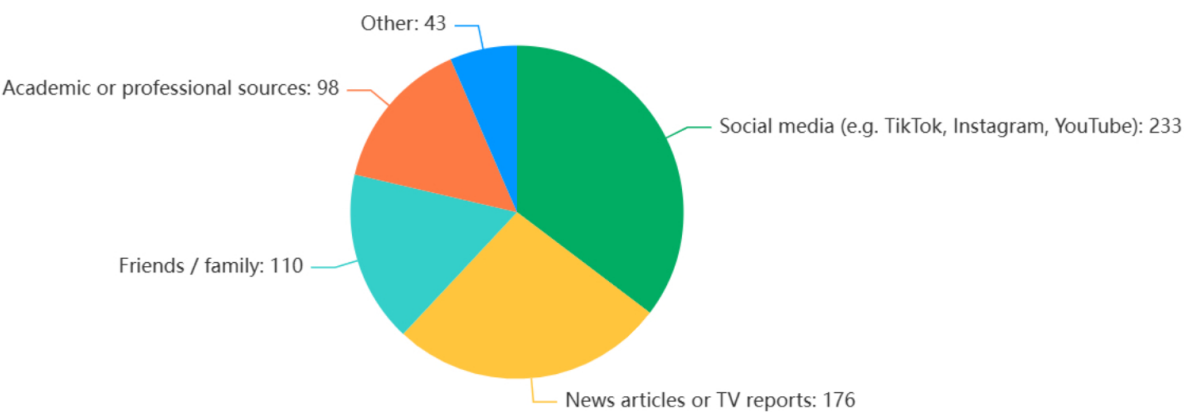
Answer Choices	Responses	Responses Percentage
Very well	84	22.76%
Moderately	153	41.46%
A little	92	24.93%
Not at all	40	10.84%
Valid Count Per Participant	369	

3. Where did you first learn about Deepfakes? [Checkboxes]

Analysis Conclusion: The data reveals that a significant majority of respondents, 63.14%, first learned about Deepfakes through social media platforms such as TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube. This indicates that these platforms are pivotal in shaping public awareness and understanding of the topic. News articles and TV reports follow as the second most common source at 47.7%, suggesting traditional media still plays a substantial role in disseminating information about Deepfakes.

However, the influence of personal networks, represented by friends and family (29.81%), and academic or professional sources (26.56%), is notably lower, indicating a potential area for improvement in educational outreach. The "Other" category, accounting for 11.65%, suggests there are additional sources not captured in the predefined options, which could be explored further.

To enhance awareness and understanding of Deepfakes, it would be beneficial to increase engagement on social media through targeted campaigns and educational content. Additionally, leveraging traditional media to provide more in-depth coverage and analysis could help reach those who rely on news articles and TV reports. Finally, fostering discussions in academic settings and among professional circles may further elevate awareness and understanding of Deepfakes among individuals who are less engaged with social media.

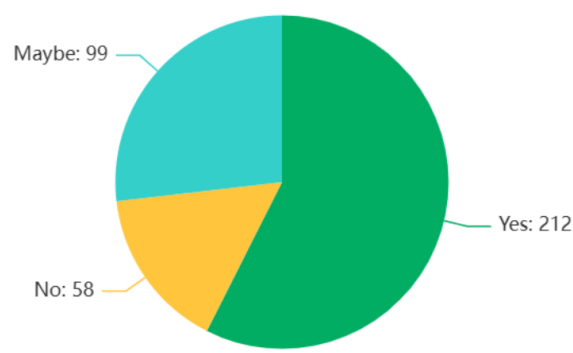


Answer Choices	Responses	Responses Percentage
Social media (e.g. TikTok, Instagram, YouTube)	233	63.14%
News articles or TV reports	176	47.7%
Friends / family	110	29.81%
Academic or professional sources	98	26.56%
Other	43	11.65%
Valid Count Per Participant	369	

4. Have you personally encountered any Deepfake videos or images online? [Multiple Choice]

Analysis Conclusion: The survey indicates that a majority of respondents (57.45%) have encountered Deepfake videos or images online, suggesting a significant awareness of this technology among the population. However, a notable portion of respondents (26.83%) are uncertain about their experiences, indicating a potential gap in understanding or recognition of Deepfakes. Only 15.72% of participants reported never having encountered such content.

To improve awareness and understanding, it may be beneficial to implement educational campaigns that inform the public about Deepfakes, their implications, and how to identify them. Additionally, providing resources or tools that help users discern authentic content from manipulated media could further enhance their ability to navigate online information effectively.



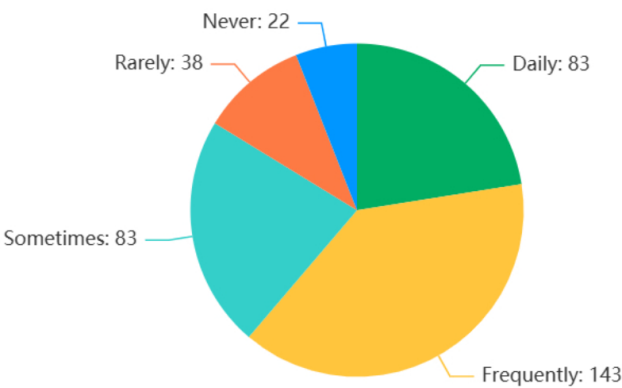
Answer Choices	Responses	Responses Percentage
Yes	212	57.45%
No	58	15.72%
Maybe	99	26.83%
Valid Count Per Participant	369	

5. How often do you think you are exposed to manipulated media online? [Multiple Choice]

Analysis Conclusion: The data indicates that a significant portion of respondents, 38.75%, believe they are frequently exposed to manipulated media online, which suggests a heightened awareness of media manipulation among the audience. Daily exposure is reported by 22.49% of respondents, indicating a concerning level of engagement with potentially misleading content. The combined total of respondents who feel exposed either daily or frequently accounts for over 60%, highlighting a critical area for intervention and education.

On the other hand, 22.49% of respondents feel they are exposed sometimes, while only a small fraction, 10.3% and 5.96%, report rare or no exposure at all. This disparity suggests that while many are aware of manipulated media, there is still a notable segment that either underestimates their exposure or is less informed about the prevalence of such content.

To improve awareness and mitigate the effects of manipulated media, it is recommended to implement educational campaigns focused on media literacy. These initiatives could provide tools and resources to help individuals critically evaluate the information they encounter online. Additionally, promoting fact-checking resources and encouraging discussions around media consumption could further enhance public understanding and resilience against manipulated content.

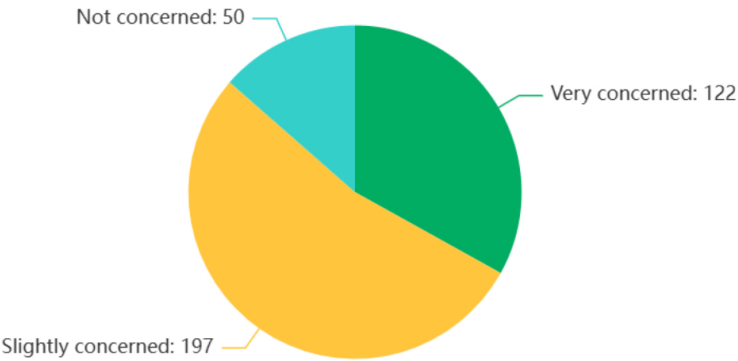


Answer Choices	Responses	Responses Percentage
Daily	83	22.49%
Frequently	143	38.75%
Sometimes	83	22.49%
Rarely	38	10.3%
Never	22	5.96%
Valid Count Per Participant	369	

6. How concerned are you about the use of Deepfakes for misinformation or fraud? [Multiple Choice]

Analysis Conclusion: The survey results indicate a significant level of concern among participants regarding the use of Deepfakes for misinformation or fraud. A combined total of 86.45% of respondents express some level of concern, with 33.06% being "Very concerned" and 53.39% "Slightly concerned." Only 13.55% of participants are "Not concerned," suggesting that the majority recognize the potential risks associated with Deepfakes.

To improve awareness and address concerns, it is recommended to implement educational initiatives that inform the public about the implications of Deepfakes. Additionally, fostering discussions around digital literacy and critical evaluation of media content could empower individuals to better discern misinformation.



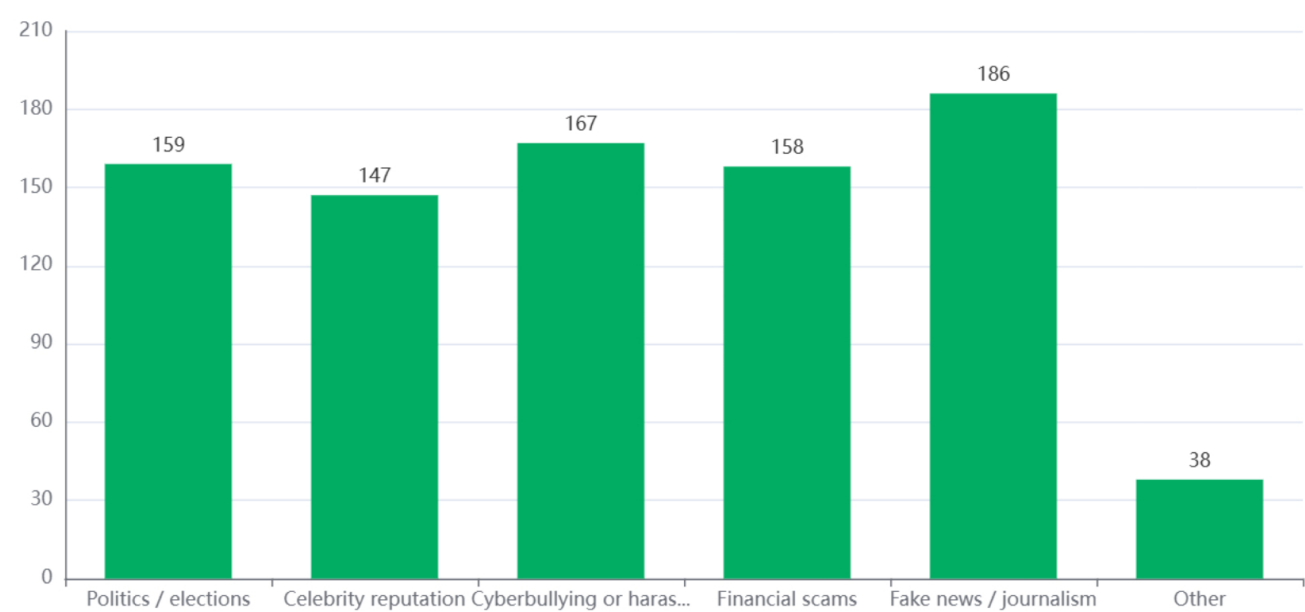
Answer Choices	Responses	Responses Percentage
Very concerned	122	33.06%
Slightly concerned	197	53.39%
Not concerned	50	13.55%
Valid Count Per Participant	369	

7. In your opinion, which areas are most at risk from harmful Deepfakes? [Checkboxes]

Analysis Conclusion: This survey reveals that the area most perceived as at risk from harmful deepfakes is "Fake news / journalism," with 50.41% of respondents identifying it as a concern. Following closely are "Cyberbullying or harassment" at 45.26% and "Politics / elections" at 43.09%. The relatively high percentages across these areas indicate a significant awareness of the potential dangers posed by deepfakes.

In contrast, the "Other" category received the least attention, with only 10.3% of respondents selecting it. This suggests that while there may be additional concerns, they are not as widely recognized or prioritized among the respondents.

To improve awareness and understanding of deepfake risks, it would be beneficial to provide targeted educational resources focusing on the implications of deepfakes in less recognized areas, particularly those mentioned in the "Other" category. Additionally, increasing public discourse around the impact of deepfakes in the realms of politics, journalism, and personal safety could foster a more informed populace.

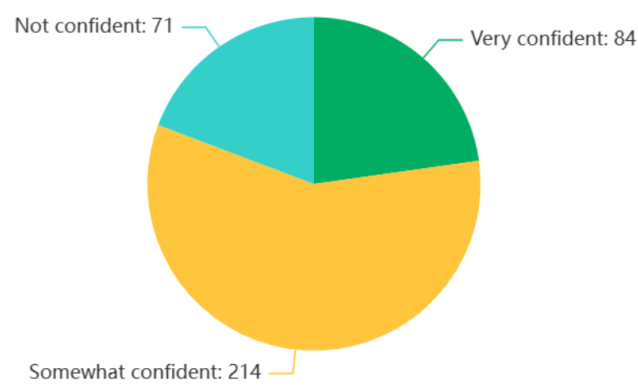


Answer Choices	Responses	Responses Percentage
Politics / elections	159	43.09%
Celebrity reputation	147	39.84%
Cyberbullying or harassment	167	45.26%
Financial scams	158	42.82%
Fake news / journalism	186	50.41%
Other	38	10.3%
Valid Count Per Participant	369	

8. How confident are you in your ability to tell if a video or image is fake? [Multiple Choice]

Analysis Conclusion: The data indicates that a significant majority of respondents feel at least somewhat confident in their ability to discern fake videos or images, with 80.75% expressing confidence (22.76% very confident and 57.99% somewhat confident). However, 19.24% of respondents reported not being confident at all, which highlights a potential area for improvement.

To enhance the overall confidence of participants, it may be beneficial to implement educational initiatives focusing on media literacy, specifically targeting the identification of fake content. Workshops, online courses, or informational campaigns could be effective in equipping individuals with the necessary skills and knowledge to better evaluate the authenticity of digital media.

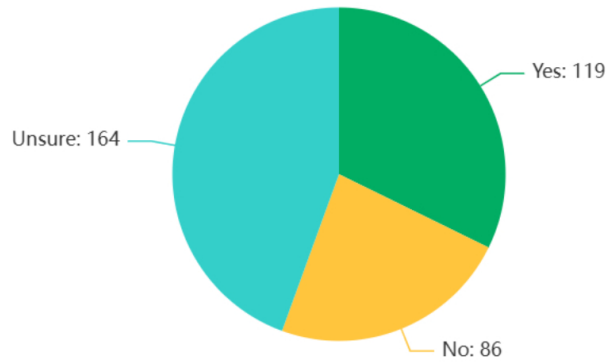


Answer Choices	Responses	Responses Percentage
Very confident	84	22.76%
Somewhat confident	214	57.99%
Not confident	71	19.24%
Valid Count Per Participant	369	

9. Would you trust an AI-based tool to help verify whether a video or image is real? [Multiple Choice]

Analysis Conclusion: The survey results indicate a significant level of uncertainty among respondents regarding the trustworthiness of AI-based tools for verifying the authenticity of videos and images. With 44.44% of participants expressing that they are "Unsure," it suggests a need for better communication and education around the capabilities and limitations of AI in this context.

The "Yes" responses, at 32.25%, indicate a moderate level of trust, while the "No" responses at 23.31% reflect skepticism about AI's reliability. To improve trust in AI-based verification tools, it would be beneficial to provide clearer information on how these tools operate, their accuracy rates, and examples of successful use cases. Additionally, engaging users in discussions about their concerns and addressing them directly could help in building confidence in such technologies.



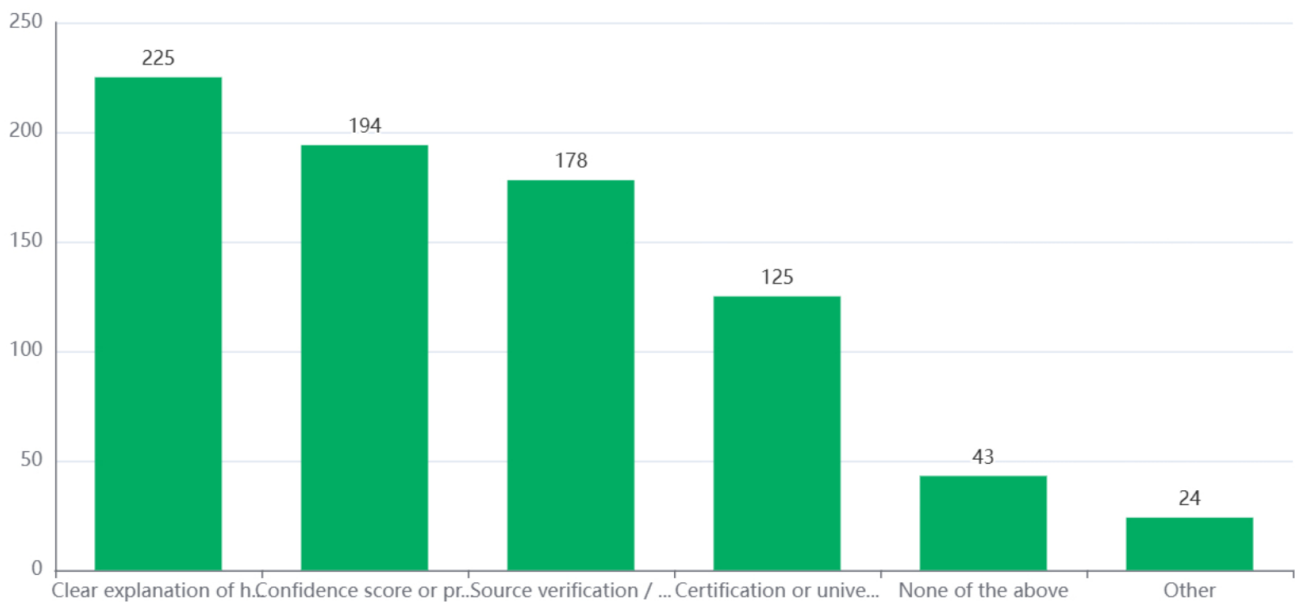
Answer Choices	Responses	Responses Percentage
Yes	119	32.25%
No	86	23.31%
Unsure	164	44.44%
Valid Count Per Participant	369	

10. Which of the following would increase your trust in such a detection tool? [Checkboxes]

Analysis Conclusion: The survey results indicate that a "Clear explanation of how the result was produced" is the most significant factor in increasing trust in detection tools, with 60.98% of respondents selecting this option. This suggests that users prioritize transparency and understanding of the processes behind the results. Following this, a "Confidence score or probability indicator" garnered 52.57%, highlighting the importance of quantifiable metrics in establishing trust. The "Source verification / metadata view" was selected by 48.24% of participants, indicating a strong interest in the credibility of the information source.

In contrast, options such as "Certification or university / government backing" (33.88%) and "None of the above" (11.65%) received lower support, suggesting that while endorsements may add some value, they are not as critical as transparency and verifiable metrics. The "Other" category, with 6.5%, reflects a need for additional insights that were not captured in the provided options.

To improve trust in detection tools, it is recommended to focus on enhancing the clarity of how results are generated, possibly through user-friendly explanations and visual aids. Additionally, incorporating confidence scores or probability indicators could further bolster user confidence. Engaging with users to explore what they consider important in the "Other" category could also provide valuable insights for future improvements.

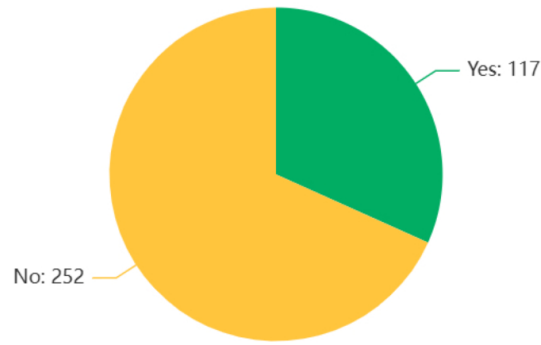


Answer Choices	Responses	Responses Percentage
Clear explanation of how the result was produced	225	60.98%
Confidence score or probability indicator	194	52.57%
Source verification / metadata view	178	48.24%
Certification or university / government backing	125	33.88%
None of the above	43	11.65%
Other	24	6.5%
Valid Count Per Participant	369	

11. Have you ever reported or flagged suspected Deepfake content on a social media platform? [Multiple Choice]

Analysis Conclusion: The data indicates that a significant majority of respondents (68.29%) have not reported or flagged suspected Deepfake content on social media platforms, while only 31.71% have taken such action. This suggests a potential lack of awareness or understanding regarding the implications of Deepfake technology and its impact on social media.

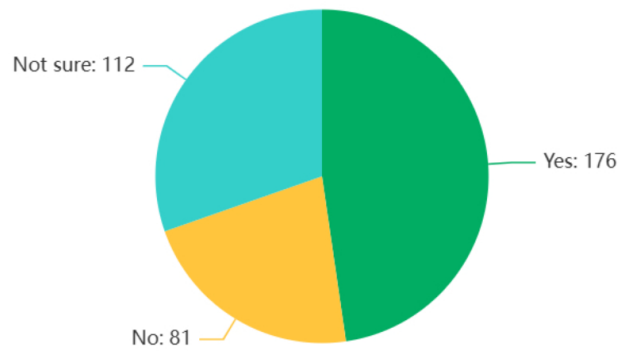
To improve the situation, it is recommended to implement educational campaigns aimed at increasing awareness about Deepfake content and the importance of reporting it. Additionally, social media platforms could enhance user interfaces to make reporting suspected Deepfake content more accessible and user-friendly, thus encouraging more users to participate in flagging inappropriate content.



12. Do you believe Deepfakes can ever have positive or creative uses (e.g., education, art, film)? [Multiple Choice]

Analysis Conclusion: The survey results indicate that a significant portion of respondents (47.7%) believes that Deepfakes can have positive or creative uses, while 21.95% are against this notion, and 30.35% remain uncertain. This suggests a generally favorable attitude towards the potential benefits of Deepfakes, particularly in fields like education, art, and film.

To improve understanding and acceptance, it may be beneficial to provide more educational resources that highlight successful examples of Deepfake technology in positive contexts. Additionally, addressing the concerns of those who are skeptical or unsure could help bridge the gap, focusing on ethical guidelines and potential safeguards to mitigate misuse.

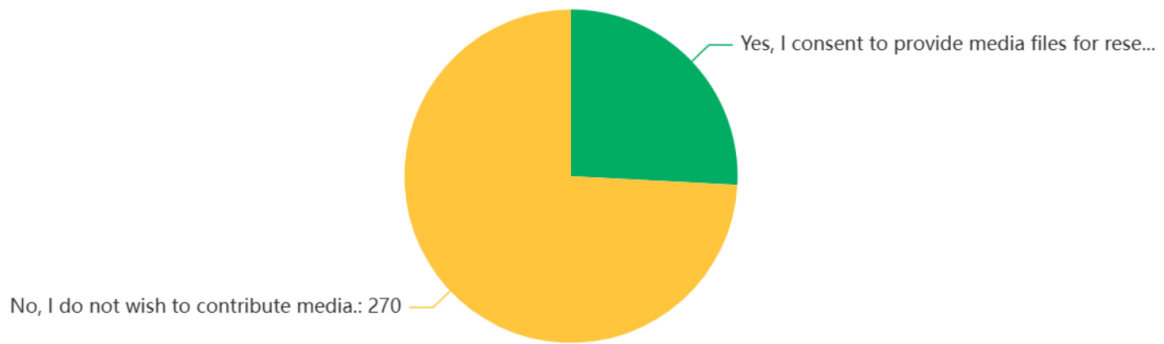


Answer Choices	Responses	Responses Percentage
Yes	176	47.7%
No	81	21.95%
Not sure	112	30.35%
Valid Count Per Participant	369	

13. Would you be willing to contribute a short, authentic video and a few facial images of yourself to support Deepfake detection research? [Multiple Choice]

Analysis Conclusion: The survey results indicate a significant reluctance among participants to contribute personal media for Deepfake detection research. With only 25.82% of respondents willing to provide videos and images, it is clear that the majority (74.18%) prefer not to participate. This disparity suggests a potential concern regarding privacy and data security among participants.

To improve participation rates, it may be beneficial to enhance communication regarding the measures taken to protect personal data and privacy. Providing clear information on how the data will be used, stored, and protected could help alleviate concerns. Additionally, offering incentives for participation or highlighting the potential benefits of the research might encourage more individuals to contribute.



Answer Choices	Responses	Responses Percentage
Yes, I consent to provide media files for research and AI model training purposes, with the understanding that all data will be processed and stored in accordance with data protection and privacy regulations.	94	25.82%
No, I do not wish to contribute media.	270	74.18%
Valid Count Per Participant	364	

14. If yes, please attach a short video clip (5–10 seconds) or 2–3 clear images of yourself where your face is visible. [Upload]

15. Please add any comments, questions, or thoughts about Deepfakes or this research. [Single Textbox]



Conclusion

This survey provides valuable insights into public awareness and perceptions regarding Deepfakes. A significant majority of respondents (66.94%) have heard of the term "Deepfake," indicating a growing recognition of this technology. However, confidence in understanding what Deepfakes are varies, with only 22.76% feeling they understand it very well.

The data reveals that social media is the primary source of information about Deepfakes, with 63.14% of participants learning about it through platforms like TikTok and Instagram. Despite this awareness, many respondents (57.45%) reported encountering Deepfake content online, suggesting a prevalence of manipulated media that raises concerns about misinformation and fraud. Notably, 86.45% of participants expressed at least some level of concern regarding the potential harmful uses of Deepfakes.

When it comes to identifying fake content, a majority (57.99%) feel somewhat confident, yet only 22.76% are very confident in their ability to discern authenticity. This highlights a potential gap in media literacy that could be addressed through education and awareness initiatives.

Interestingly, while trust in AI-based verification tools is moderate—32.25% would trust such tools—there is a strong desire for transparency in how these tools operate. Clear explanations and confidence scores emerged as key factors that could increase trust in detection technologies.

The survey also suggests a cautious but open-minded attitude towards the creative uses of Deepfakes, with 47.7% believing they can have positive applications in fields like education and art. However, a significant number of respondents (74.18%) are unwilling to contribute personal media for research purposes, indicating privacy concerns that need to be addressed.

In summary, this survey underscores the need for increased public education about Deepfakes, the risks associated with them, and the development of trustworthy verification tools. As Deepfake technology continues to evolve, fostering a more informed and vigilant public will be essential in mitigating its potential harms while exploring its creative possibilities.